

Sophie Cresswell Williams

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SUMMARY OF SKILLS

Technical: ESRI Suite, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, ERDAS Imagine, handheld GPS, Python, R, SPSS, Microsoft Suite - Word, PowerPoint, Excel

Quantitative: Data acquisition, validation, analysis, and visualization using GIS, Excel, Microsoft, and SPSS interfaces

Project management: Creating and coordinating diverse multi-stakeholder project teams, file organization, data management, and effective communication

Writing and editing: Technical reports, academic research articles, web content, correspondence

Languages: Fluent in Spanish, basic French

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Geography

2022

The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL

Concentration: Geographic Information Systems

Thesis: *Change Detection and Marine Management in South Water Caye Marine Reserve, Belize*

Relevant coursework: Environmental Decision-Making, Remote Sensing, Advanced GIS, GIS Programming, Environment and Society, Research Methods in Geography, Quantitative Methods

Bachelor of Science in Biology

Bachelor of Arts in English

2018

The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, Gulf Restoration Office

Spatial Ecologist

August 2022 - Present

341 N Greeno Rd, Fairhope, AL

Spatial Analysis, Data Management, and Cartography

- Produce innovative, effective maps for internal program and public audiences, including basemaps for the Programmatic Review of the Deepwater Horizon oil spill settlement and ESRI Experience pages to support Inflation Reduction Act funding allocation
- Manage diverse spatial and non-spatial datasets for several restoration projects, including the Strategic Approach for Bird Restoration Evaluation, a dataset inventory and gap analysis
- Develop and execute Project Ledger database tool that summarizes and queries information for over 680 restoration projects funded by the Deepwater Horizon oil spill settlement

Project Management and Partnership

- Manage the North Breton Island Restoration Project, which applies \$72 million in funding for restoration of barrier island habitats to support nearshore shorebird and seabird nesting

- Coordinate the data visualization for the North Breton Island Restoration Project, which will help interpret and share the open data on the long-term effectiveness of restoration on diverse restoration types with the public

Community Involvement

- Lead the Spatial Analysis working group of the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service's Southeast Region GIS Community of Practice by connecting with members, providing technical support, and designing and facilitating events including webinars, workshops, and office hours

The University of Alabama

Graduate Teaching Assistant: Geography 101

August 2021 - May 2022

513 University Blvd, Tuscaloosa, AL

- Prepared lecture material and exercises for ten laboratory classes on Earth's atmospheric processes and patterns
- Supported students through each assignment during each lab session with real-life applied examples, collective work, and one-on-one assistance

U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service Directorate Fellowship Program

Gulf Restoration Office Fellow

May 2021 - August 2021

341 N Greeno Rd, Fairhope, AL

- Created a visual risk assessment map showing the risk that chemical hazards pose to species listed under the Endangered Species Act throughout the southeast US
- Synthesized information from scientific literature and other projects in the agency to develop the project's GIS methodology and the risk assessment framework, which weighted spatial datasets for visualization and analysis
- Produced web mapping applications, static and interactive maps, a project report, and an ArcGIS StoryMap to document and share project products with a wide variety of audiences
- Promoted project outcomes in presentations, meetings, and reporting channels to educate restoration practitioners

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

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| • Exceeding Expectations and Outstanding Performance Ratings | 2023 |
| • Special Thanks and Recognition (STAR) Award for Customer Service | 2023 |
| • The University of Alabama National Alumni Association Fellowship | 2020, 2022 |
| • Conference of Latin Americanist Geographers Field Study Grant and Travel Award | 2021 |

TRAINING

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| • Introduction to Structured Decision Making, National Conservation Training Center | 2023 |
| • U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service National Geospatial Training Workshop | 2024 |

PUBLICATIONS

- 2021: **Williams, Sophie C.** "Ritual and Research: Notes from the Field." *Geographical Bulletin* 62(2B), 125-27.
- 2023: **Williams, Sophie C.**, Michael K. Steinberg, and Jordan R. Cissell. "Change Detection and Marine Management in South Water Caye Marine Reserve, Belize." *Environmental Biology of Fishes* 106(2), 209-220.
- 2024: **Williams, Sophie C.**, Jordan R. Cissell, and Michael K. Steinberg. "Consumption and Conservation in Belize's Queen Conch Fishery." *FOCUS on Geography*. 10.21690/foge2024.67.4p/